AUWA

The Beginning

—

Eko Maeda

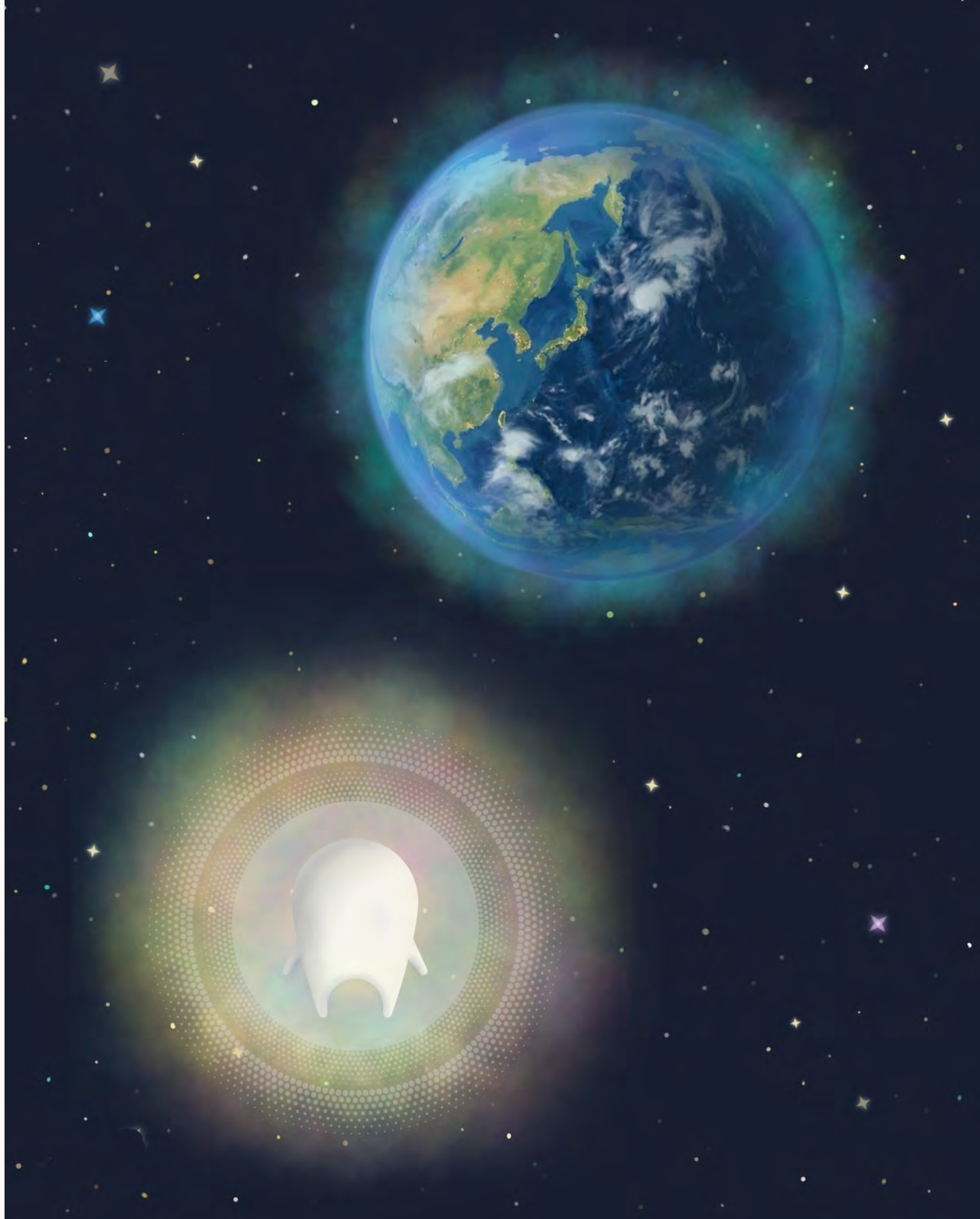
In one of countless galaxies, a small blue planet was waiting.

A signal was reaching across the universe, faint but persistent, like a heartbeat in the dark. The stars of WAWA gathered their light and sent it toward Earth.

Their light merged into a single glowing being.
They named it AUWA. And with a heart full of joy,
AUWA set off toward Earth.

AUWA crossed space in an instant and appeared before the blue planet. Earth had been waiting, quietly, for a very long time.

"Go," said Earth softly. *"See everything for yourself."*



Slipping through the atmosphere, AUWA discovered
a sky painted in colours that didn't exist back home.

Below lay a deep, quiet forest. AUWA sensed something alive down there. Something small, barely holding on.

The forest was quiet and still. Most of its life had long since faded. But at the foot of an old tree, one small blue flower was still here. AUWA reached out with a gentle light.

From within the flower, something glowed softly.
Her Kokoro. Her soul.

Every living thing and every object carries a Kokoro.
You cannot see it. But when AUWA's gentle light
touches it, a Kokoro appears.

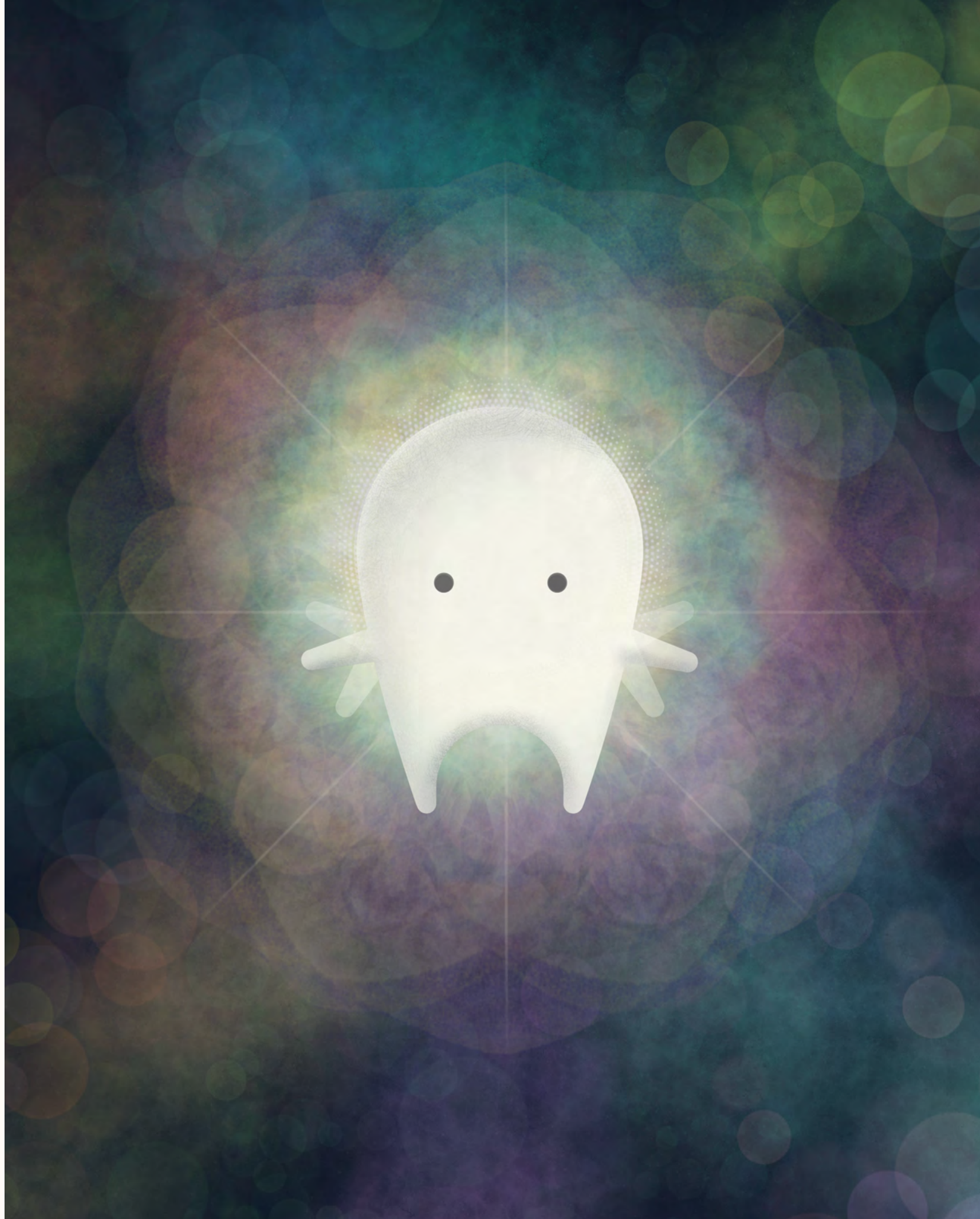
Her name was Bluu.

She remembered a time when the forest hummed with life, and friends bloomed in every direction.

That time had passed. But Bluu was still here.

"I feel so lonely," she said quietly.

AUWA closed both eyes.
And held Bluu's happiest memory close.
Then, gently, let it go.



The forest blossomed with blue flowers, all around, all at once. Bluu's Kokoro sparkled and returned to her flower.

"*Thank you, AUWA.*" she whispered.

AUWA kept exploring. The ground ahead was sparkling with a quiet, strange light.

Curious, AUWA sent a gentle shower of light into the earth. And from the soil, a new Kokoro appeared.

It was the Kokoro of the microbes, tiny creatures living deep in the forest soil.

"*Hello, AUWA. We know your name. We know everything you have done tonight.*"

AUWA was surprised. "*But we only just met. How do you know?*"

"We live beneath every step you take.
We share what we know with every root, every creature, every living thing."

"We are all connected, though you cannot see it."

The microbes called out to all their friends.
One by one, tiny lights rose from the soil.
And together, they began to sing.

"I-Me, You-Me, He-Me, She-Me,
We connect, we connect, we connect and become one.
I-Me, You-Me, He-Me, She-Me,
Our soul, our land, our star, we are all One..."

AUWA listened until the last note faded.
Then, with a warm heart, stepped back into
the night sky. The forest glowed below.

The adventure was far from over.